Inclusive group work and assessment

Is group work structured for equitable participation?

EQUITY / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Group work is structured (role rotation, agreements) to prevent reproducing inequities

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

The same course requirement can land very differently depending on time, money, care, disability, work, housing or confidence. Equity asks whether students with different lives have a real opportunity to participate and succeed, rather than simply receiving the same rule.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “This course assumes university is the only thing happening in my life.”
- “I can technically enrol, but the way this is organised makes participation fragile.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Set clear roles and expectations rather than leaving everything to social negotiation.
- Build in checkpoints and escalation routes.
- Consider how availability, confidence and prior experience may shape who does what.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A group project includes role planning, a team agreement and a midpoint reset so workload and communication can be recalibrated.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to structure group assessment so roles, contribution expectations and peer processes support equitable participation. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

GO FURTHER AT UQ

Explore UQ guidance for assessing teams and groups

Assessing teams and groups

Designing assessment